Eoin Morgan, together with Andrew Strauss and Trevor Bayliss, should take all credit for the transformation of England's one-day team. To be honest, he was given a hospital pass when he took the squad into the 2015 World Cup. That didn't end well; I will always remember Straussy promising, 'These next four years will be different.'

It took someone with his foresight to make the decision to change, and force England to take white-ball cricket more seriously. Eoin's team consciously tried to be trendsetters, to play aggressively and aspire to scoring 400 from their fifty overs. He had the confidence to trust his players, even when they were occasionally questioned for failing to bat out their allocation.

The leadership he showed, in facing up to the criticism, and suggesting he'd prefer the positivity of making a total of, say, 330 from forty-three overs, was exceptional. Watching from afar, his captaincy was authentic. He possessed the talent and presence of mind to back up his fearless philosophy. Sometimes, arriving at the crease with England on 20–2, he would take the brave option and immediately walk down the wicket, knowing he would be slaughtered if it went wrong.

Ironically the final, tied on 241, was old school. If ever there was anyone you'd have cried out for as a captain, to see us home with 80 from 100 balls, it was Jonathan Trott. That's ironic, but it is no coincidence that the one consistent factor between the heroes of 2019 and our team, which became world number one in 2011, was Andrew Strauss.

He's a special bloke, the most rounded person, in my experience, ever to come out of cricket. He is one of those great leaders who excel in different roles and environments. As my captain, he had vision and drive. As my boss, as England's director of cricket, he demonstrated decisiveness and insight. As my friend, he showed kindness and empathy.

He took me, as a young opening batsman, under his wing. His wife Ruth acted similarly with Alice, guiding her through the balancing act between sport and family. They were our guiding lights. Ruth's loss, to cancer, was tragic. It shook us, as a couple. It impacted on the entire cricket community. Her goodness will endure, through the charitable foundation established in her name.

I met Andrew a couple of days after the World Cup final, at the premiere of *The Edge* , a film about our number one team. He had undergone a traumatic year, but I could see in his eyes the quiet satisfaction of a job well